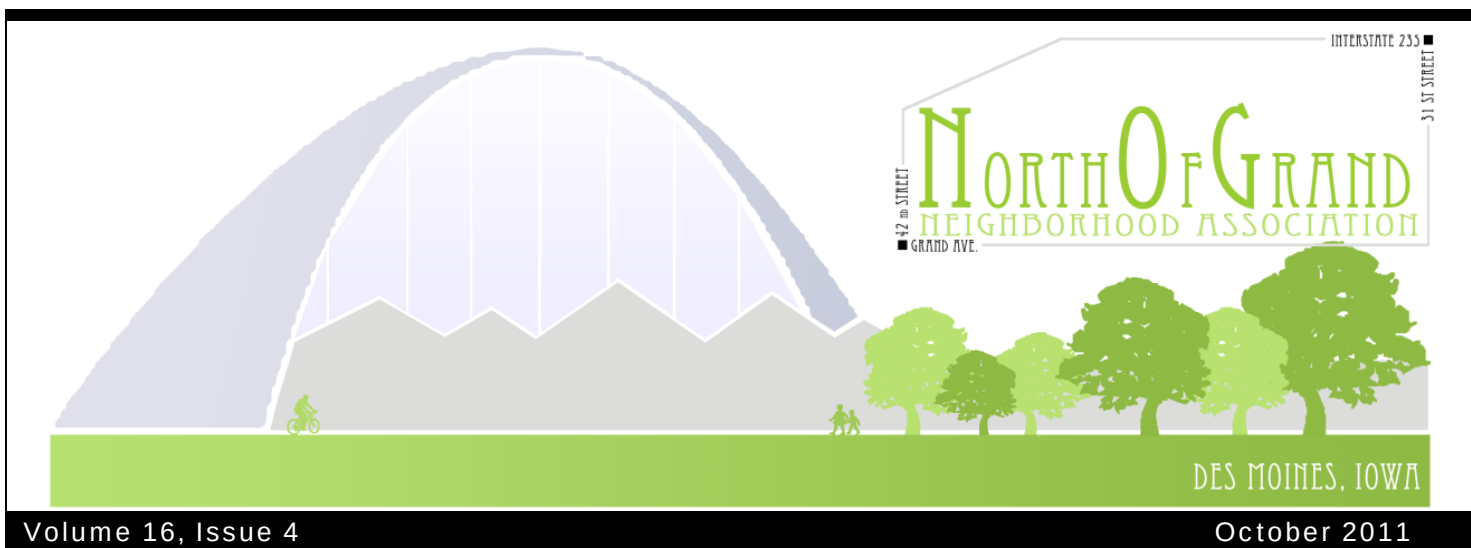




NOG Quarterly Meeting

Tuesday, November 14th at 7 pm
Grand Suite, 3801 Grand Avenue

Guest Speaker:

Jim Jacobsen of History Pays!

James "Jim" Jacobsen is a well-known local historic researcher with a wealth of knowledge about the National Register of Historic Places.

He has successfully completed many neighborhood surveys and nominations in Iowa, including NOG's Middlesex National Historic District (2000). He meets the Secretary of the Interior's Professional Qualifications Standards and owns an architectural research consulting firm, History Pays!

NOG Board Elections

Come to the November 14th meeting and cast your vote. If you are interested in serving on the board of directors, please contact board member Justin Gross. The following seats are up for re-election or are open this year;

President:	Kimberly Hansen
Vice President:	Mark Siegfried
Treasurer:	Matt Braafhart
At-Large:	Nathan DeCock
At-Large:	Ben Malloy

Board members meet on the 3rd Wednesday of each month at 7 pm. Attendance at Quarterly membership meetings is also an expectation. Also, participation on committees/events is requested. Terms start Jan 1st 2012.

A Toast to North of Grand!

On Oct. 9th, about 35 visitors toasted Polk County, the State Historical Society of Iowa, and the City of Des Moines for seeing the value in learning more about the former fine folks of this community, and about the bricks and mortar, shingles and shutters.



The Greenwood Park Plat Intensive Survey is an exciting opportunity (39th to 42nd, Grand to Center). It is possible that, like the Middlesex National Historic District a few blocks away, some structures in the Greenwood Park Plat may be determined eligible to the National Register of Historic Places.

This determination opens the door to substantial benefits, such as state historic tax credits to offset renovation costs. These incentives do not restrict the rights of property owners in the use, development, or sale of private historic property. National Register designation honors the history of our nation, Iowa and Des Moines.

Architectural historian Jim Jacobsen will guide us on this exploration to learn more about the one of the best, mixed use, historic neighborhoods in Iowa.

In This Issue:

- Quarterly Meeting and Board Position Elections
- A Toast to North of Grand
- Greenwood Plat Intensive Survey
- Archive Training
- SURVEY: Get to know your home
- Did You Know?
- Ingersoll Business Committee Calendar

GREENWOOD PLAT INTENSIVE SURVEY

Reminder: Please join us for a presentation by Jim Jacobsen, architectural historian working on the "Greenwood Park Plat Intensive Survey." The regular North of Grand Neighborhood Association quarterly meeting followed by board elections will start at 7 p.m.. Nov. 14, at 3801 Grand Ave. (if you're facing the structure, it's the front entrance on the west (left). Additional parking in the rear of the facility. Free and open to all.

Thanks to the terrific participation at our recent gatherings, we have some great results, which we'll share during the meeting.

Some volunteers have asked if it'd be OK to share individual contact information (name, email address, specific area of interest on the project). Could you please let me know if you'd rather NOT have that go out to the group?

Finally, we're trying to determine the old fair's boundaries/location. There is a 1884 Sanborn Fire Insurance map of the Brown's Woods-Iowa State Fair that shows some wells, cisterns and other structures. Could you please ask around whether any neighbors have discovered any wells or cisterns on their property?

Archive Training Opportunity

Dec. 6, 7-7:45 p.m., at second floor computer lab, Central Library, 1000 Grand Avenue.: Joe Hyman will provide a free training on how to use on-line City Directories (1866-1922). This is an invaluable resource when researching names, addresses, occupations, businesses of early Des Moines.

Here is the link to the city directories on Archive.org (sorted by date):

<http://www.archive.org/search.php?query=collection%3Adesmoinesandpolkcounty%2Fcitydirectories&sort=-date>

For parking and other info, go to

<http://desmoinespubliclibrary.com/>

If you have any specific questions, Joe's email is jphyman@dmpl.org We truly appreciate Central Library for providing this service.

YOUR PARTICIPATION IS APPRECIATED!

The Greenwood Park Plat Intensive Survey encompasses properties from 39th to 42nd and from Grand to I-235, but we are also capturing data from where Middlesex National Historic District ends, east side of 35th to 42nd Streets and from Grand Avenue to I-235). Current or former residents and property owners are encouraged to complete. Thank you!

House Address: _____

The purpose of this simple survey is to find out what you already know about your house. No research is required. We just want to get a basic understanding of what is already known about your house. Towards the end of the survey project we can compare new information to this beginning information and see what was learned.

House Design and Construction: Please write down the construction year of your house, exact if known, or estimated. If you know who designed it and built it, write that down as well!

House Alterations: Please list any known major changes and if you know when those changes were made, give those dates as well. List any fire or other accidental damages too.

House History: Here list any known owners or tenants. What we are interested here is identifying original owners (who built the house) or long-term residents in the house.

House Stories: Note any unusual or interesting stories that you know about the house. You can either go into detail or just reference the story and we can document it later (like "double axe murder, 1954" or "friendly ghost lives in the basement")

Could you please lend us any historic photos, abstract or other documents to review and scan/copy? All documents will be returned.

Your contact information:

Name: _____

Email address: _____

Please send info to Jim Jacobsen at hp@raccoon.com or call at 274-3625

DID YOU KNOW??

Just a reminder for the proper disposal of leaves, if you decide to rake your yard this fall. The most common disposal method in Des Moines is with yard waste bags. You must use bags that have the "Metro Waste Authority" logo on them. If you use any other type bag or box you must put an authorized waste tag on it. These can be purchased at some local grocery and hardware stores. Remember, curb pick-up items should be put on the curb no more than 12 hours prior to pick up and containers removed within 12 hours after pick-up. You are NOT allowed to rake or sweep leaves into the street or onto the sidewalk:

Sec. 98-115. Disposal of yard debris.(1) A degradable bag bearing the Compost It! logo of the Metro Waste Authority and sold for that purpose by the Metro Waste Authority;(2) A 64- or 96-gallon solid waste container issued by the public works department and bearing a sticker issued by the public works department designating such container for use for collection of yard debris;(3) A cardboard box not larger than 24 × 24 × 36 inches or degradable store brand yard waste paper bag bearing a sticker issued by the Metro Waste Authority designating such box or bag for use for collection of yard debris; or(4) Such bags, containers, boxes, or bundles, when placed for collection, shall not contain more than 40 pounds of yard debris.(c) There shall be no limit on the number of bags, containers, boxes, or bundles of yard debris that may be placed for collection on a single collection day, unless a limit is temporarily imposed by the city manager in an emergency situation.

Sec. 98-115. Composting

(d) As an alternative to the placement of yard debris in bags, containers, boxes, or bundles for curbside collection, persons owning or residing in single-family residences may dispose of yard debris by composting, if such composting meets the following requirements:

(1) Composting may be conducted on the premises of a single-family residence only if the lot upon which the residence is located has an area of not less than 5,000 square feet.

(2) A compost pile shall not be located less than 50 feet from any neighboring dwelling.

(3) Each compost pile shall be fenced to screen it from view from neighboring residences and to prevent wind from scattering debris.

(4) Compost piles shall be established and maintained in accordance with recognized guidelines or those provided to the city's solid waste collection customers or otherwise published by the public works department; provided, however, that household food waste, scrap food or garbage shall not be composted with or added to a yard debris compost pile.

(5) Compost piles which are not properly fenced resulting in the dispersal of debris or which create odors resulting in complainants by neighboring residents or which, in the judgment of the public works department sanitation superintendent or the office of environmental health, create a risk of fire or other threat to public health, safety, or welfare shall, when so ordered by the sanitation superintendent or the office of environmental health, be removed from the premises and disposed of by curbside collection as provided in this section.

Sec. 102-9. Bonfires.

No person, either by himself or herself or through his or her employee, agent or servant, shall rake or place leaves, grass or any rubbish or material on any street, sidewalk, parking, alley or public grounds or set fire to or attempt to burn or to burn the material on any street, sidewalk, border area, alley or public ground.

If you have any questions on disposal of leaves, or anything else give me a call.

Ed Leedom N.B.S.D. elleedom@dmgov.org

515-283-4183 – office

515-208-0299 - cell



Ingersoll Business Committee Calendar

Friday, November 11

West Side Story: A Reflection and Celebration of 2011

5-7 PM

Badower's

2817 Ingersoll Ave.

Wednesday, November 16

Wake-Up Westside

7:30-8:30 AM

Marc Stephens & Friends Salon

3200 Ingersoll Ave.

NOG Memberships

In efforts to streamline the process of how North of Grand memberships are renewed - paper invoices were mailed to everyone in February. The amount due will be your dues for the calendar year of 2011. If you have any questions - please contact Kimberly Hansen at 279-2684.

2011 Dues:

General Membership is open to everyone.

Voting members must live, work, rent, or own property within the NOG boundaries

Individual:	\$12 per year
Household:	\$22 per year
Business:	\$30 per year
Patron:	\$50 per year

North of Grand Neighborhood Association
P.O. Box 12027
Des Moines, IA 50312

2011 Membership Invoices

Please consider joining or renewing your membership

We value your support in 2011!



Neighborhood Based Service Delivery

If you have concerns about a problem in your neighborhood or have a question regarding city services and you're not sure who to call, please contact the following individuals: **Des Moines Police Dept. Sgt. Vince Valdez or City Code Enforcement Inspector Ed Leedom 283-4183.**

North of Grand Neighborhood Association

Board of Directors

- **President:** Kimberly Hansen 279-2684
kimberlymhansen@aol.com
- **Vice President:** Mark Siegfried 255-7667
Marksally2@mchsi.com
- **Treasurer:** Matt Braafhart 279-6945
matt@braafhart.com
- **Secretary:** Mathew Coen 274-9513
mcoen@StudioCOENarch.com
- **Co-Secretary:** Sarah Oltrogge
sarah.oltrogge@earthlink.net
- **At Large:** Ben Molloy 277-4387
yurikakanai-molloy@mchsi.com
- **At Large:** Shawn Miller 221-2989
miller.shawn@principal.com
- **At Large:** Colleen Kinney 664-9183
mcfet6@mchsi.com
- **At Large:** Nathan DeCock 943-6008
nfdecock@gmail.com
- **At Large:** Justin Gross 238-6079
jons@2rm.com

Hope to see you at our meeting on November 14th!

www.northofgrandneighborhood.org

Find us on FACEBOOK: North of Grand DSM

IMPORTANT DATES

October 30, 2011, 2-4 PM: "Abstract Party," the Stavneak residence, 637 41st Street. Dig out your abstract or other old documents to share with the architectural historian. These legal records can shed light on early developers and property transactions. We will have a scanner and copier.

Nov. 7, 2011, 9-10:30 AM: "Records, Records, Records." Meet near south entrance of Argonne Armory Building, 602 Robert D. Ray Drive. Search old building permits and inspection records (starting in 1917) to help verify age of structures, plat location, builder name, property value, and alterations.

Nov. 14, 2011, 7 PM: North of Grand quarterly meeting, 3801 Grand Avenue. Board elections. Meet the architectural historian and discuss project plans. Contact NOG board president Kimberly Hansen, kimberlymhansen@aol.com or (515) 279-2684 for more information.

Dec. 3, 2011, 9-11 AM: Research Day. Find out what resources the State Historical Society of Iowa Historical Library has to offer. Meet in the library reading room at 600 E. Locust (east entrance). While you're there, visit the historic streetcar exhibit "Swing & Sway: Iowa's Electric Railways" in the Historical Museum, featuring artifacts from the Ingersoll line. Free.

January 8, 2012, 3-5 PM: Central Presbyterian Church Fireside Room, 3829 Grand Avenue. Consultant will present preliminary findings.

Feb. 12-March 18, 2012: Exhibit of historic photos and maps from the neighborhood, open daily at Zanzibar's Coffee Adventure, 2327 Ingersoll Avenue. If you have images to share, please contact NOG board member Sarah Oltrogge, (515) 971-4364, sarah.oltrogge@earthlink.net. All documents will be returned.

Feb. 13, 2012: North of Grand Quarterly meeting, 7 p.m., Plymouth Place, 4111 Ingersoll Ave. Updates about project.

May 8, 2012: North of Grand Quarterly meeting, 7 p.m., 3801 Grand Avenue. Presentation from consultant.

ABOUT

The mission of the North of Grand Neighborhood Association (NOG) is to ensure that existing and projected infrastructure systems are managed or developed so they enhance the physical, visual and spatial qualities of the neighborhood - promoting a healthy climate for area businesses, and public and private properties.

The NOG Board of Directors would like to sincerely thank the residents, area businesses, Polk County, the City of Des Moines and the State Historical Society of Iowa for supporting (we proudly believe) one of the most attractive, mixed-used neighborhoods in Iowa.

2011-2012 NOG BOARD OF DIRECTORS

Kimberly Hansen, President

Matt Braafhart

Colleen Kinney

Matt Coen

Ben Molloy

Nathan DeCock

Sarah Oltrogge

Justin Gross

Mark Siegfried

Sgt. Vince Valdez, Des Moines Police Department

Neighborhood Based Service Delivery

Ed Leedom, Inspector, City of Des Moines

Neighborhood Inspection Division

CREDITS

Cover photo by Tim Bungert: Fire station #12, 535 40th Street. Built 1900.

Inside photo 1 (middle column): Private home at 613 41st St. Built 1911.

Inside photo 2 (right column): Private home at 526 40th St. Built 1906.

Graphic design by Sarah Oltrogge

SUPPORTERS

Thank you to the following organizations for their generous support of the Greenwood Park Plat Intensive Survey:



DOCUMENTING
HISTORY

Greenwood Park Plat Intensive Survey
2011 - 2012



NORTH OF GRAND
NEIGHBORHOOD ASSOCIATION

PROJECT GOAL

Thanks to the support of the City of Des Moines, and funding from Polk County and the State Historical Society of Iowa's Historic Resource Development Program, an architectural historian will be hired to conduct THE GREENWOOD PARK PLAT INTENSIVE SURVEY of about 225 properties from 39th to 42nd streets, and Grand Avenue to Center Street in the North of Grand Neighborhood of Des Moines, Iowa. Some properties and districts within these boundaries may be deemed eligible for the National Register of Historic Places.

PROJECT BACKGROUND

In 2010 the North of Grand Neighborhood Association commemorated nearly 200 properties that had reached the century mark. While planning for the celebration, we discovered early records describing how the 1879 Iowa State Fair was held in this area, known back then as Brown's Park. Old maps showed a lake, named for William L. White, whose name appears on the legal descriptions of properties near 39th and Woodland. Since the Centennial Celebration, residents have been curious about how these charming historic homes came to be developed, and by whom. What historic and economic factors contributed to the houses to be developed? Did the topography shape the development and design of the streets and structures? Did transportation play a role in the early development of the neighborhood? We know in 1890 Ingersoll and Grand Avenue dummy line was operated by the Des Moines Rapid Transit Co. Later Ingersoll Avenue became a streetcar line then an interurban route.

Today, the Ingersoll corridor serves 12,000-17,000 vehicles daily. Our safe, affordable, tree-lined neighborhood along Ingersoll remains popular today due to its close proximity to shops, restaurants, the bus line, well-established churches, fine schools and historic architecture.



NATIONAL REGISTER OF HISTORIC PLACES

Being listed on the National Register of Historic Places (NRHP) helps honor our neighborhood's past while welcoming the district's future as part of a dynamic, mixed-use neighborhood of Des Moines. There are high costs involved when properties are allowed to deteriorate (vandalism, crime, foreclosures, loss of property tax revenues, loss of architectural heritage, etc.). Residents can take pride in rehabilitated properties, which will help reduce blight, curb crime and boost the economic vitality of the area.

Another part of our neighborhood has already been honored with this designation. In 2000, a study was completed of the 37-acres between 31st and 35th streets and from Center Street to Woodland Avenue. This area was placed on the NRHP as the Middlesex Plat Historic District.

Owners of property within a National Historic District may apply for state historic tax credits when rehabilitating their homes. The value, if awarded, is equal to 25% of the approved project costs. Commercial (income-producing) property owners may apply for federal historic tax credits. These types of rehabilitation plans are subject to review by the staff of the State Historic Preservation Office (SHPO). www.iowahistory.org/historic-preservation

It is important to note that these financial incentives do NOT restrict the rights of the property owners in the use, development, or sale of a private historic property.

HOW YOU CAN HELP

Volunteers are needed to compile information about properties between 39th and 42nd and between Grand Avenue and Center Street.

We are planning some group research "parties" that will teach participants hands-on information gathering techniques and a great opportunity to get to know your neighbors. Things like city legal documents, building permits, property value and past alterations all need to be noted. This type of "legwork" will be invaluable to the consultant.

Contact survey organizer Colleen Kinney at (515) 664-9183 or mcfet6@mchsi.com for more information.



ABOUT THE CONSULTANT

James "Jim" Jacobsen is a well-known local historic researcher with a wealth of knowledge about the National Register of Historic Places. He has successfully completed many neighborhood surveys and nominations in Iowa, including NOG's Middlesex National Historic District (2000). He meets the Secretary of the Interior's Professional Qualifications Standards and owns an architectural research consulting firm, History Pays! **Jim Jacobsen, (515) 274-3625, hp@raccoon.com**

